

hypothesis

Microsoft .Net

▲ What is it?

Microsoft is building a complete solution with .Net, which transcends Web services to deliver an Internet experience, from desktop and desktop services to content providers, Internet services and ultimately, payment.

▲ What is the technology?

The new .Net strategy aims to revolutionise the way Microsoft and developers, who work on Microsoft platforms, deliver software. Microsoft aims to phase out delivering software per se, and instead will deliver these as Web services over the Internet. Consumers of those services will license it as an on-demand service and the software will, at least theoretically, be installed automatically.

▲ Should I care?

Microsoft's desktop monopoly governs how over 96 per cent of the people worldwide access the Internet. If it successfully ties the desktop monopoly to Microsoft-held Internet properties, .Net will be a major force to reckon with.

SNAPSHOT 70 per cent

of all Internet porn traffic occurs during the 9-to-5 workday (SexTracker)
The average time spent online by workers at the office (compared to average 9.5 hours at home) is
21 hours

Source: www.nielsen-netratings.com

Pump up the volume!

Loudspeakers conventionally come in heavy, cumbersome boxes that provide an air enclosure to absorb unwanted vibration and give a fuller sound. But now UK-based Ellula Sounds and US-based SoundTube Entertainment, reckon an inflatable box will do the job. SoundTube is developing inflatable speakers



that bands can carry flat and inflate when they arrive at the venue.

A Loughborough University's student spin out company, Ellula Sounds has won the Best Innovative Product prize at the National Incentive Show in UK for the new speakers.

Adbusters get busted

Web site operators will soon have a new tool to block the blockers. Many Web surfers have been weeding out banner and pop-up ads by resorting to software such as AdKiller, AdSubtract, and Proxy.

Web site operators dependent on ads for revenue are now changing their act to counter these filters. And here's where

AdKey comes in. This software, developed by MediaBEAM, is currently in the beta testing stage.

AdKey will allow operators to deny access to users who have installed ad filters. Such users will get a message stating that they can either switch off the filter or pay a fee for advertising-free services.

Microsoft opens Passport ... a wee bit

Microsoft is being criticised for using its might to get users to sign up for its Passport service. The idea behind Passport is that users can use it to have a unified login to sites across the Web instead of having five, 10, or 20 different usernames and passwords across a variety of Web properties. To get the unification benefit, users must put their information into Passport, and Web sites must also

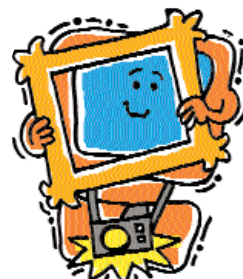


use Passport to offer a login for their users.

A 'federated' model for Passport was announced by Microsoft with the goal being, "...to build an Internet 'trust network,' where a single, common authentication system [is] to be used across enterprise systems, Web sites and services." With this, users will be able to choose a third-party 'Internet trust network provider' to store the data.

Diposable Digital Camera

You don't have to drop the camera roll at the photo shop anymore. Just drop the entire camera. Three Japanese companies have decided to come up with an experimental commercial service involving disposable digital cameras. Pentax cameras, Sanyo Electric and Altech have announced the three-month trial.



Illustrations: Farzana Cooper

The service lets users pick up a 310,000-pixel Pentax digital still camera, take their photos, and then return the camera to the store they picked it up from. At the store, they can view all the photo images on a display screen and choose the ones to be printed.

These companies collect the used cameras from the stores, delete the image data, and repack the cameras for use again. Customers are under no obligation to return the camera to the store or collect their prints, once the service fee is paid. With the manufacturing cost of the camera more than the service fee, profitability relies on how many cameras can be collected and recycled. The companies plan to expand the services to the Internet for data distributing and printing.

◆ Salon.com begins charging ◆ Nero enables DVD creation, uses MP3PRO ◆ Sony unveils DVD Walkman ◆ Yahoo! to start charging for